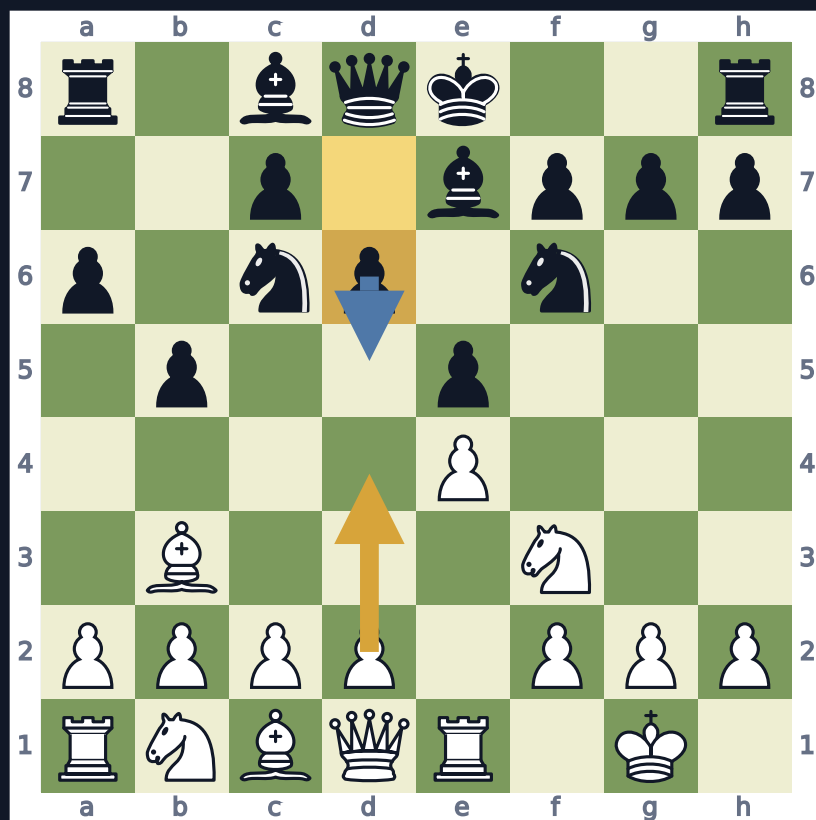


12

The Breyer Defense

Why the knight returns, how Black prepares ...d5, and White's kingside accumulation.



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

You will decode the Breyer's hidden logic and use move orders as a plan map rather than ritual.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate candidates for the side to move, identify the opponent's strongest resource, and choose the resulting structure you can explain. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 067 | PAGE 4

Decode: Vacating c6 for the c-pawn

Vacate a square only when another piece or pawn has a valuable claim to it.

LESSON 068 | PAGE 8

Play: Vacating c6 for the c-pawn

Vacate a square only when another piece or pawn has a valuable claim to it.

LESSON 069 | PAGE 12

Decode: The ...Bf8 defensive regrouping

A good defensive piece prevents a break now and returns to activity later.

LESSON 070 | PAGE 16

Play: The ...Bf8 defensive regrouping

A good defensive piece prevents a break now and returns to activity later.

LESSON 071 | PAGE 20

Decode: Preparing the freeing ...d5

Preparation has an expiry date; break when every piece supports the transformation.

LESSON 072 | PAGE 24

Play: Preparing the freeing ...d5

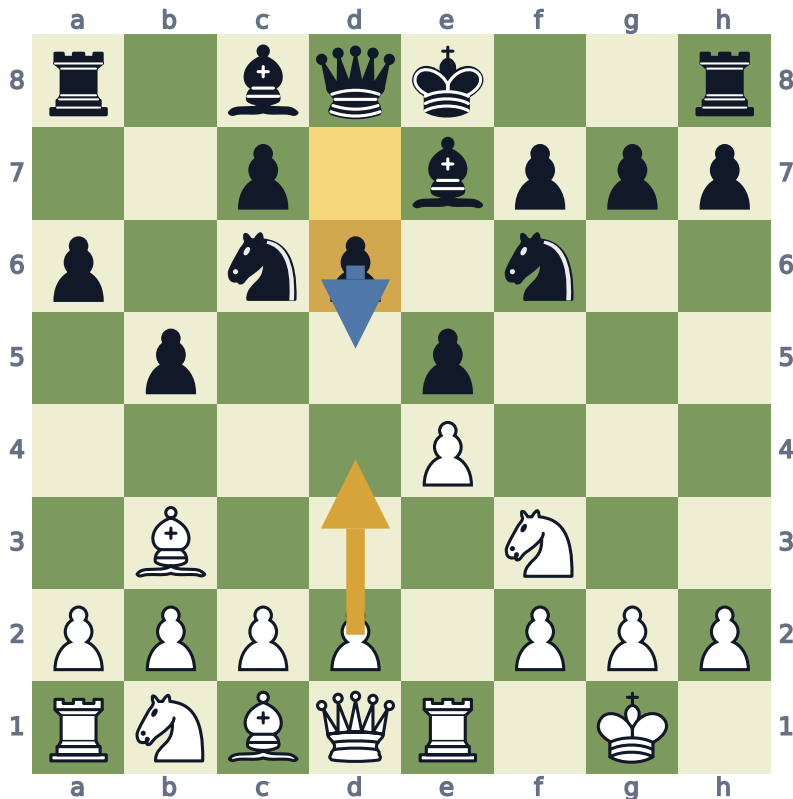
Preparation has an expiry date; break when every piece supports the transformation.

VOLUME OBJECTIVE

You will decode the Breyer's hidden logic and use move orders as a plan map rather than ritual.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Vacating c6 for the c-pawn



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...Nb8 lets the c-pawn move, sends the knight to d7, and supports e5 without blocking the b7 bishop.

DECISION RULE

What concrete central or queenside move becomes possible only because c6 is empty?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Complete ...Nbd7 and ...Bb7, then choose ...Re8, ...Bf8, and ...d5 in an order that meets White's threats.

WHITE'S RESOURCES

White uses the retreat tempo to occupy space with d4 and improve the queenside knight.

MEMORY RULE | Vacate a square only when another piece or pawn has a valuable claim to it.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

...Nb8 lets the c-pawn move, sends the knight to d7, and supports e5 without blocking the b7 bishop.

BLACK'S PLAN

Complete ...Nbd7 and ...Bb7, then choose ...Re8, ...Bf8, and ...d5 in an order that meets White's threats.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S PLAN

White uses the retreat tempo to occupy space with d4 and improve the queenside knight.

FAILURE MODE

Playing the Breyer retreat in a position where c6 is still the knight's best defensive square.

DECISION TEST

Ask: What concrete central or queenside move becomes possible only because c6 is empty? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

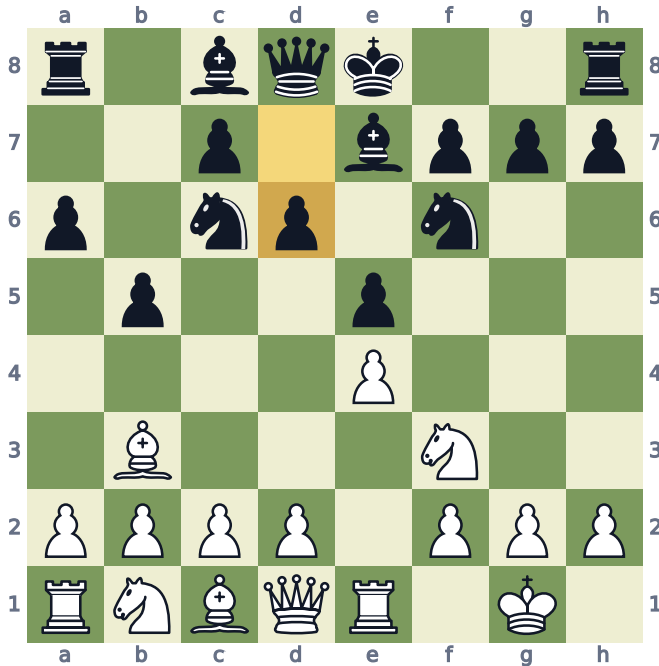
RULE | Vacate a square only when another piece or pawn has a valuable claim to it.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 O-O 9. h3 Nb8 10. d4 Nbd7



- O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- Be7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Re1: White places a rook behind a file or pawn break expected to become important.
- b5: Black gains bishop tempo and queenside space while creating a possible pawn target.
- Bb3: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- d6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...Nb8 lets the c-pawn move, sends the knight to d7, and supports e5 without blocking the b7 bishop.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

What concrete central or queenside move becomes possible only because c6 is empty? White's resource is: White uses the retreat tempo to occupy space with d4 and improve the queenside knight. The line fails as a template when: Playing the Breyer retreat in a position where c6 is still the knight's best defensive square.

STORE THIS | Vacate a square only when another piece or pawn has a valuable claim to it.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

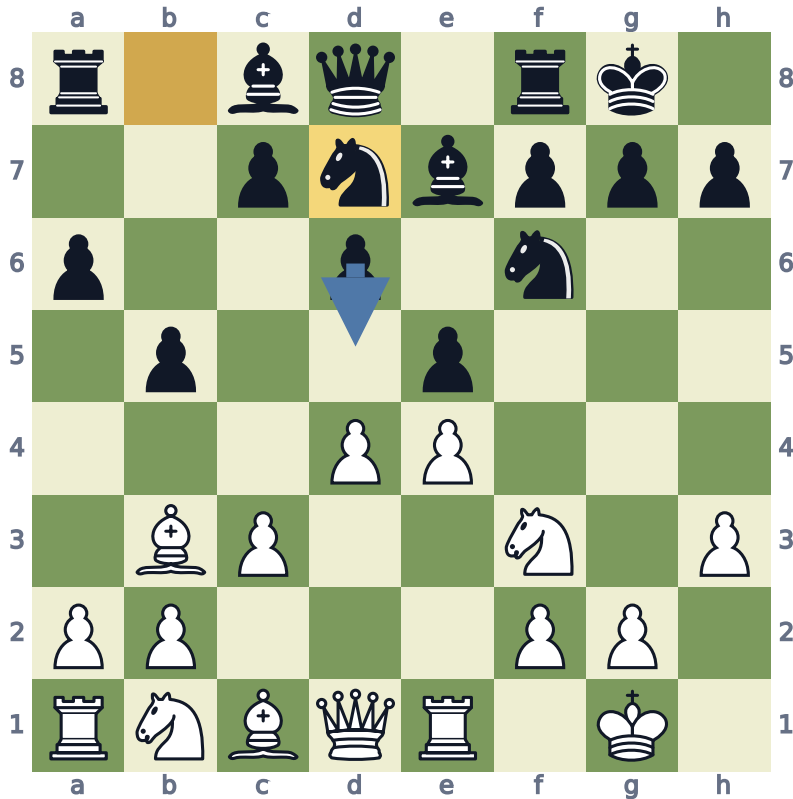
1. ...Nb8 lets the c-pawn move, sends the knight to d7, and supports e5 without blocking the b7 bishop. 2. Complete ...Nbd7 and ...Bb7, then choose ...Re8, ...Bf8, and ...d5 in an order that meets White's threats. 3. White uses the retreat tempo to occupy space with d4 and improve the queenside knight. 4. What concrete central or queenside move becomes possible only because c6 is empty? 5. Playing the Breyer retreat in a position where c6 is still the knight's best defensive square.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 14 plies from memory, then replay: 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Vacating c6 for the c-pawn



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...Nb8 lets the c-pawn move, sends the knight to d7, and supports e5 without blocking the b7 bishop.

DECISION RULE

What concrete central or queenside move becomes possible only because c6 is empty?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Complete ...Nbd7 and ...Bb7, then choose ...Re8, ...Bf8, and ...d5 in an order that meets White's threats.

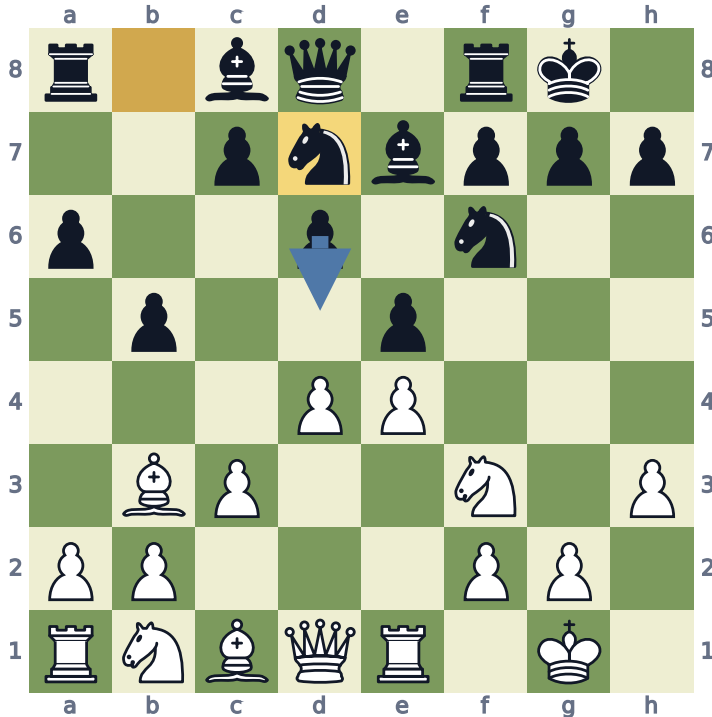
WHITE'S RESOURCES

White uses the retreat tempo to occupy space with d4 and improve the queenside knight.

MEMORY RULE | Vacate a square only when another piece or pawn has a valuable claim to it.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

...Nb8 lets the c-pawn move, sends the knight to d7, and supports e5 without blocking the b7 bishop.

BLACK'S PLAN

Complete ...Nbd7 and ...Bb7, then choose ...Re8, ...Bf8, and ...d5 in an order that meets White's threats.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S PLAN

White uses the retreat tempo to occupy space with d4 and improve the queenside knight.

FAILURE MODE

Playing the Breyer retreat in a position where c6 is still the knight's best defensive square.

DECISION TEST

Ask: What concrete central or queenside move becomes possible only because c6 is empty? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

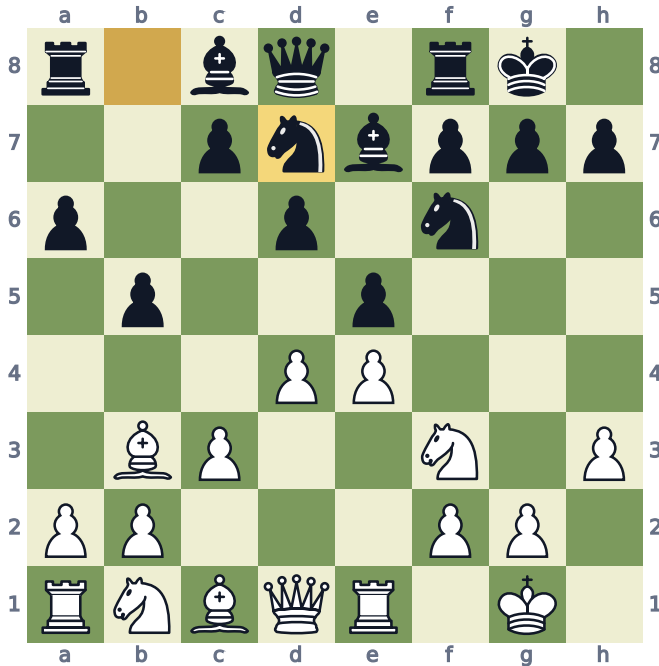
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 O-O 9. h3 Nb8 10. d4 Nbd7



- c3: White supports d4 and reserves c2 as a retreat square for the Spanish bishop.
- O-O: Black secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- h3: White prevents a pin and supports the coming central plan at the cost of one tempo.
- Nb8: Black reroutes a knight to b8; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- d4: White challenges e5 and opens lines after the preparatory pieces are ready.
- Nbd7: Black reroutes a knight to d7; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...Nb8 lets the c-pawn move, sends the knight to d7, and supports e5 without blocking the b7 bishop.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

What concrete central or queenside move becomes possible only because c6 is empty? White's resource is: White uses the retreat tempo to occupy space with d4 and improve the queenside knight. The line fails as a template when: Playing the Breyer retreat in a position where c6 is still the knight's best defensive square.

STORE THIS | Vacate a square only when another piece or pawn has a valuable claim to it.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

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4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

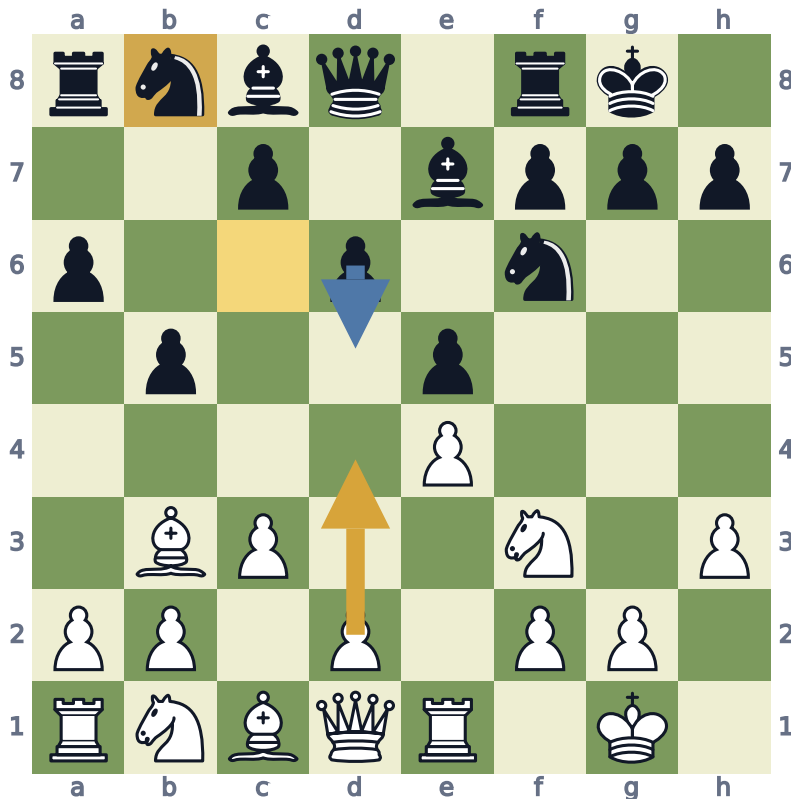
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 20 plies from memory, then replay: 8. c3 O-O 9. h3 Nb8 10. d4 Nbd7

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The ...Bf8 defensive regrouping



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...Bf8 protects g7 and h6, supports the king, and clears e7 for other pieces while keeping the bishop for a later diagonal.

DECISION RULE

What square is the bishop defending now, and what event will release it later?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Use the bishop as a defensive anchor, then reactivate it after the center or kingside structure changes.

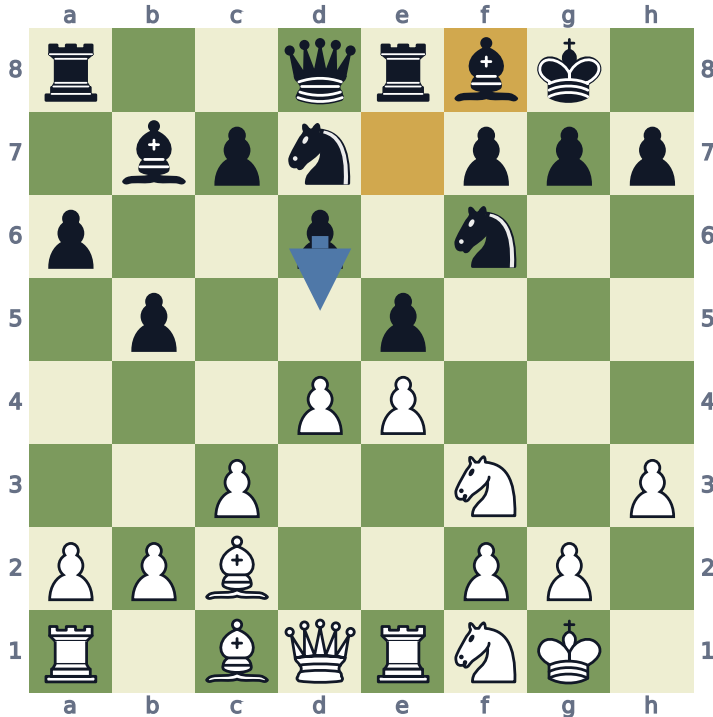
WHITE'S RESOURCES

White adds Ng3, a4, and kingside pressure, trying to make Black's regrouping too slow.

MEMORY RULE | A good defensive piece prevents a break now and returns to activity later.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

...Bf8 protects g7 and h6, supports the king, and clears e7 for other pieces while keeping the bishop for a later diagonal.

BLACK'S PLAN

Use the bishop as a defensive anchor, then reactivate it after the center or kingside structure changes.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S PLAN

White adds Ng3, a4, and kingside pressure, trying to make Black's regrouping too slow.

FAILURE MODE

Calling a defensive retreat complete without a reactivation plan.

DECISION TEST

Ask: What square is the bishop defending now, and what event will release it later? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

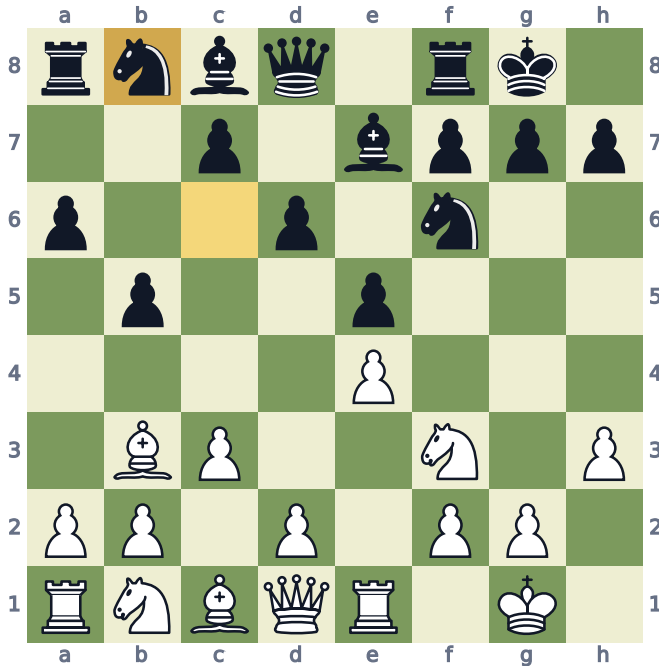
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 O-O 9. h3 Nb8 10. d4 Nbd7 11. Nbd2 Bb7 12. Bc2 Re8 13. Nf1 Bf8



- Bb3: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- d6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- c3: White supports d4 and reserves c2 as a retreat square for the Spanish bishop.
- O-O: Black secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- h3: White prevents a pin and supports the coming central plan at the cost of one tempo.
- Nb8: Black reroutes a knight to b8; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...Bf8 protects g7 and h6, supports the king, and clears e7 for other pieces while keeping the bishop for a later diagonal.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

What square is the bishop defending now, and what event will release it later? White's resource is: White adds Ng3, a4, and kingside pressure, trying to make Black's regrouping too slow. The line fails as a template when: Calling a defensive retreat complete without a reactivation plan.

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COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

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ANSWER KEY

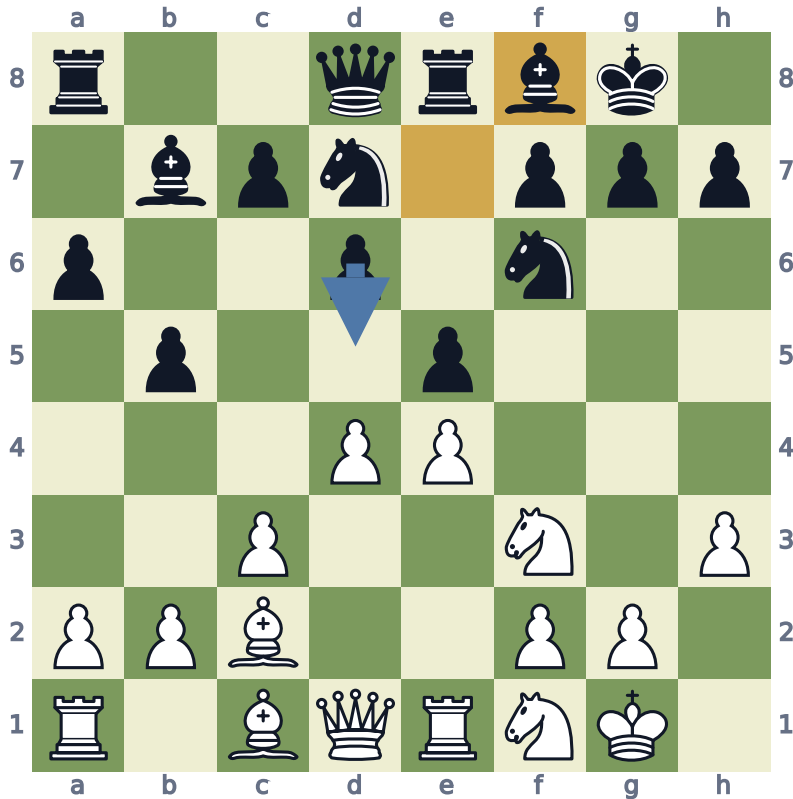
1. ...Bf8 protects g7 and h6, supports the king, and clears e7 for other pieces while keeping the bishop for a later diagonal. 2. Use the bishop as a defensive anchor, then reactivate it after the center or kingside structure changes. 3. White adds Ng3, a4, and kingside pressure, trying to make Black's regrouping too slow. 4. What square is the bishop defending now, and what event will release it later? 5. Calling a defensive retreat complete without a reactivation plan.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 O-O 9. h3 Nb8

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The ...Bf8 defensive regrouping



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...Bf8 protects g7 and h6, supports the king, and clears e7 for other pieces while keeping the bishop for a later diagonal.

DECISION RULE

What square is the bishop defending now, and what event will release it later?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Use the bishop as a defensive anchor, then reactivate it after the center or kingside structure changes.

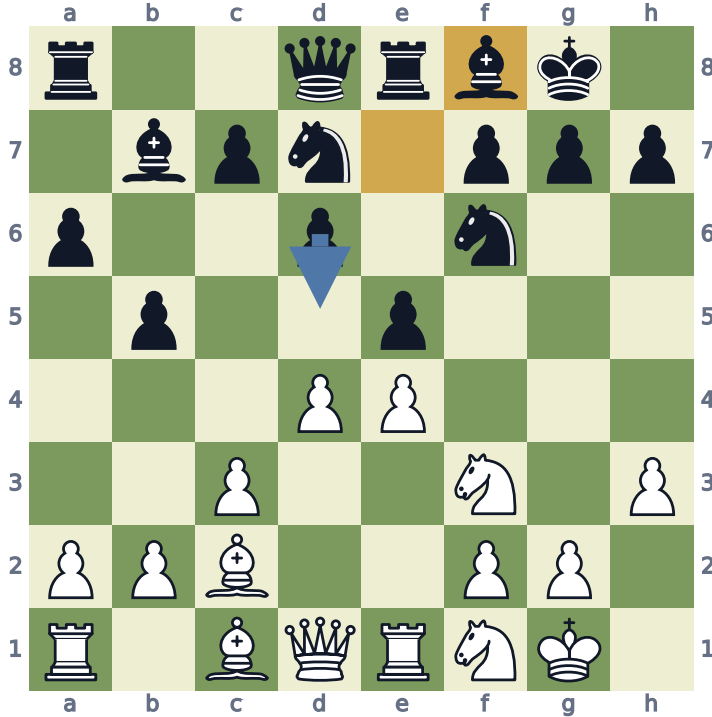
WHITE'S RESOURCES

White adds Ng3, a4, and kingside pressure, trying to make Black's regrouping too slow.

MEMORY RULE | A good defensive piece prevents a break now and returns to activity later.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

...Bf8 protects g7 and h6, supports the king, and clears e7 for other pieces while keeping the bishop for a later diagonal.

BLACK'S PLAN

Use the bishop as a defensive anchor, then reactivate it after the center or kingside structure changes.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S PLAN

White adds Ng3, a4, and kingside pressure, trying to make Black's regrouping too slow.

FAILURE MODE

Calling a defensive retreat complete without a reactivation plan.

DECISION TEST

Ask: What square is the bishop defending now, and what event will release it later? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

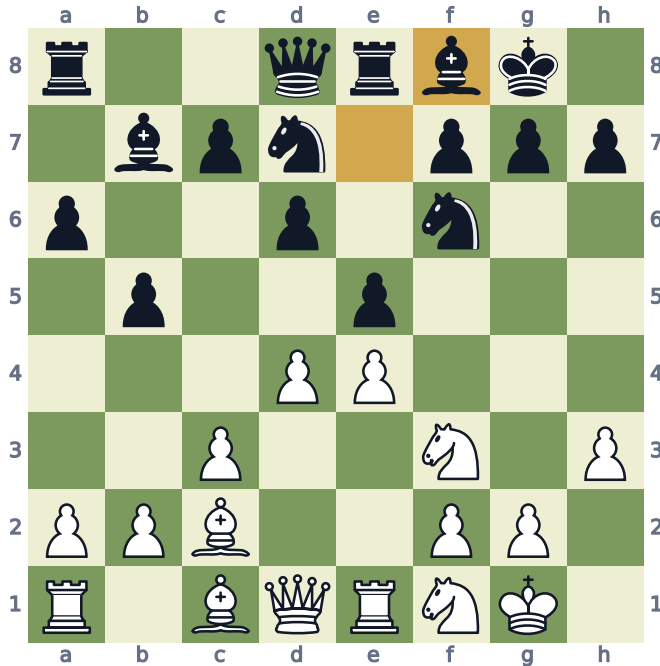
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 O-O 9. h3 Nb8 10. d4 Nbd7 11. Nbd2 Bb7 12. Bc2 Re8 13. Nf1 Bf8



- Nbd2: White reroutes a knight to d2; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Bb7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Bc2: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Re8: Black places a rook behind a file or pawn break expected to become important.
- Nf1: White reroutes a knight to f1; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Bf8: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...Bf8 protects g7 and h6, supports the king, and clears e7 for other pieces while keeping the bishop for a later diagonal.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

What square is the bishop defending now, and what event will release it later? White's resource is: White adds Ng3, a4, and kingside pressure, trying to make Black's regrouping too slow. The line fails as a template when: Calling a defensive retreat complete without a reactivation plan.

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COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

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4. What exact question decides the next move?

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ANSWER KEY

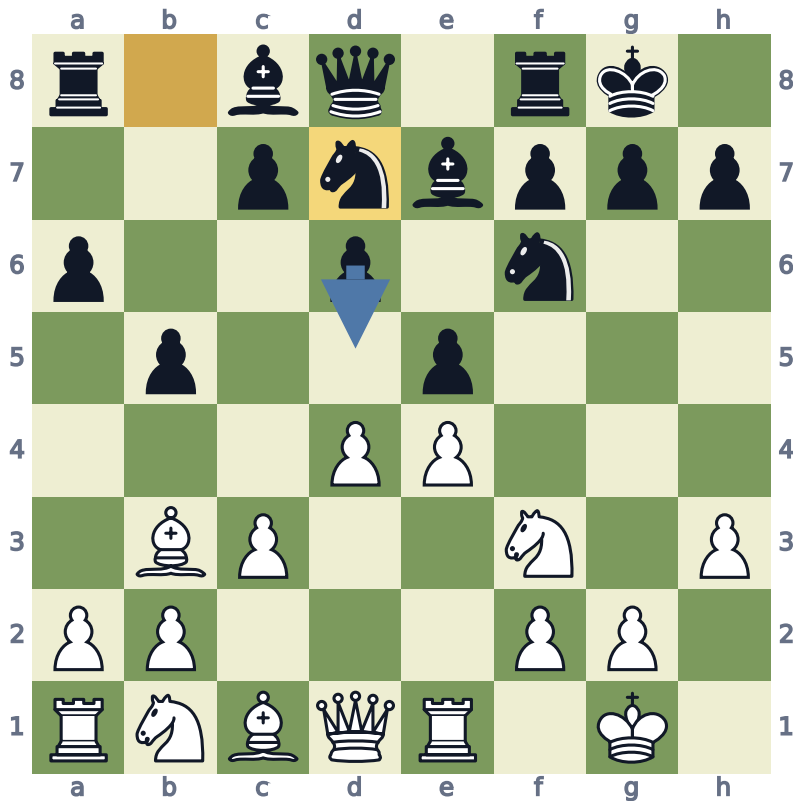
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 26 plies from memory, then replay: 11. Nbd2 Bb7 12. Bc2 Re8 13. Nf1 Bf8

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Preparing the freeing ...d5



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

The Breyer's moves reinforce e5 and organize the pieces so ...d5 can challenge White's center without tactical collapse.

DECISION RULE

If ...d5 is played, which white capture or advance is strongest and where do the black pieces go afterward?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Complete coordination, watch d5 and e4 tactics, and play the break when exchanges free the bishops and rooks.

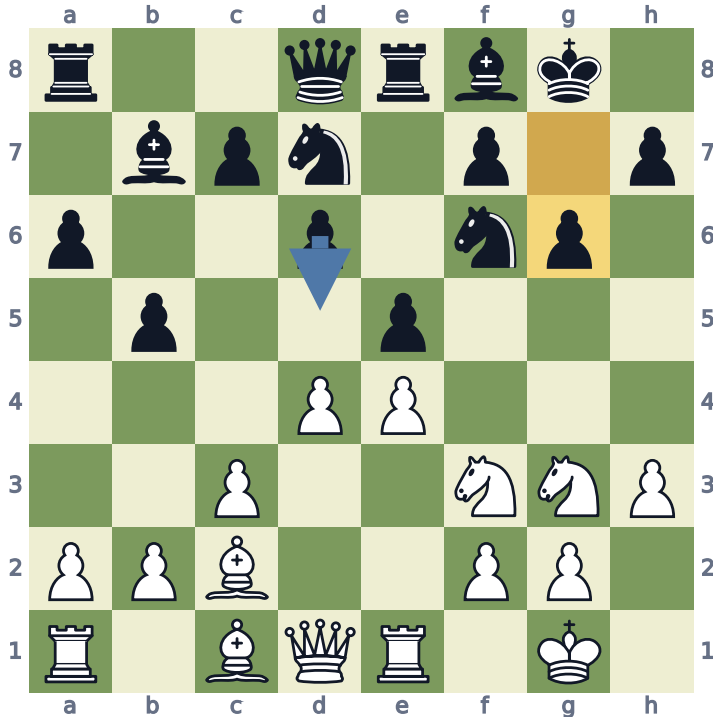
WHITE'S RESOURCES

White restrains ...d5, uses a4, and builds kingside pressure while Black prepares.

MEMORY RULE | Preparation has an expiry date; break when every piece supports the transformation.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The Breyer's moves reinforce e5 and organize the pieces so ...d5 can challenge White's center without tactical collapse.

BLACK'S PLAN

Complete coordination, watch d5 and e4 tactics, and play the break when exchanges free the bishops and rooks.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S PLAN

White restrains ...d5, uses a4, and builds kingside pressure while Black prepares.

FAILURE MODE

Delaying the break beyond the moment of readiness until White's space squeeze becomes permanent.

DECISION TEST

Ask: If ...d5 is played, which white capture or advance is strongest and where do the black pieces go afterward? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

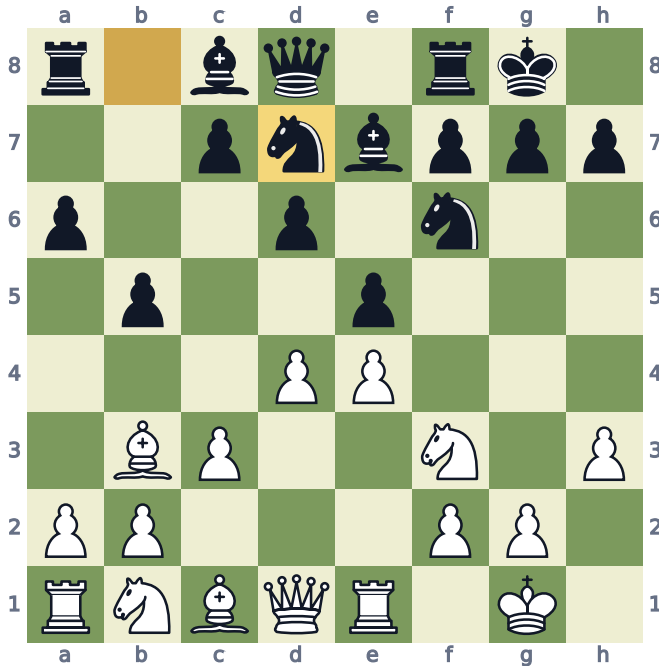
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

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- c3: White supports d4 and reserves c2 as a retreat square for the Spanish bishop.
- O-O: Black secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- h3: White prevents a pin and supports the coming central plan at the cost of one tempo.
- Nb8: Black reroutes a knight to b8; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- d4: White challenges e5 and opens lines after the preparatory pieces are ready.
- Nbd7: Black reroutes a knight to d7; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The Breyer's moves reinforce e5 and organize the pieces so ...d5 can challenge White's center without tactical collapse.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

If ...d5 is played, which white capture or advance is strongest and where do the black pieces go afterward? White's resource is: White restrains ...d5, uses a4, and builds kingside pressure while Black prepares. The line fails as a template when: Delaying the break beyond the moment of readiness until White's space squeeze becomes permanent.

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COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

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ANSWER KEY

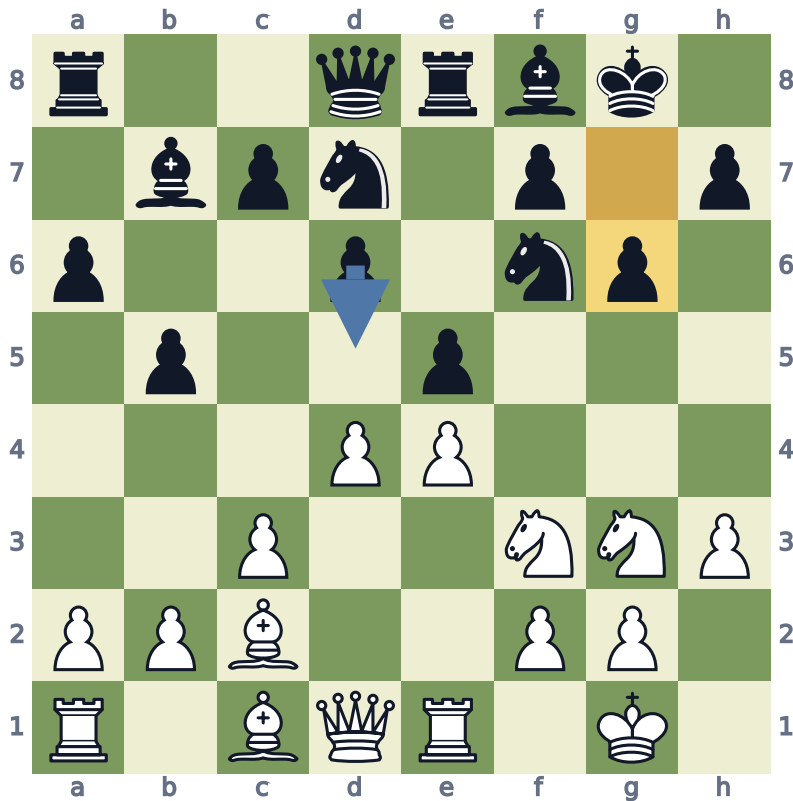
1. The Breyer's moves reinforce e5 and organize the pieces so ...d5 can challenge White's center without tactical collapse. 2. Complete coordination, watch d5 and e4 tactics, and play the break when exchanges free the bishops and rooks. 3. White restrains ...d5, uses a4, and builds kingside pressure while Black prepares. 4. If ...d5 is played, which white capture or advance is strongest and where do the black pieces go afterward? 5. Delaying the break beyond the moment of readiness until White's space squeeze becomes permanent.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 20 plies from memory, then replay: 8. c3 O-O 9. h3 Nb8 10. d4 Nbd7

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Preparing the freeing ...d5



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

The Breyer's moves reinforce e5 and organize the pieces so ...d5 can challenge White's center without tactical collapse.

DECISION RULE

If ...d5 is played, which white capture or advance is strongest and where do the black pieces go afterward?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

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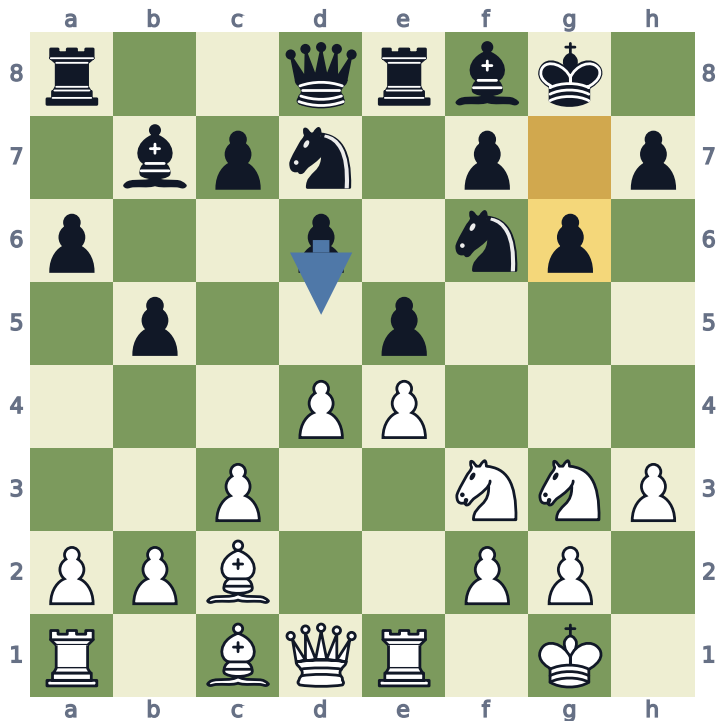
WHITE'S RESOURCES

White restrains ...d5, uses a4, and builds kingside pressure while Black prepares.

MEMORY RULE | Preparation has an expiry date; break when every piece supports the transformation.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The Breyer's moves reinforce e5 and organize the pieces so ...d5 can challenge White's center without tactical collapse.

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FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S PLAN

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FAILURE MODE

Delaying the break beyond the moment of readiness until White's space squeeze becomes permanent.

DECISION TEST

Ask: If ...d5 is played, which white capture or advance is strongest and where do the black pieces go afterward? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

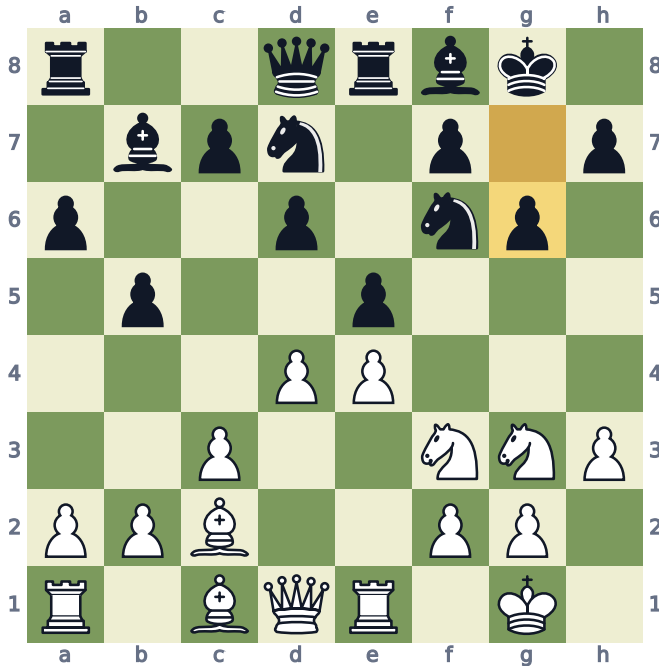
RULE | Preparation has an expiry date; break when every piece supports the transformation.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 O-O 9. h3 Nb8 10. d4 Nbd7 11. Nbd2 Bb7 12. Bc2 Re8 13. Nf1 Bf8 14. Ng3 g6



- Bc2: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Re8: Black places a rook behind a file or pawn break expected to become important.
- Nf1: White reroutes a knight to f1; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Bf8: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Ng3: White reroutes a knight to g3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- g6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The Breyer's moves reinforce e5 and organize the pieces so ...d5 can challenge White's center without tactical collapse.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

If ...d5 is played, which white capture or advance is strongest and where do the black pieces go afterward? White's resource is: White restrains ...d5, uses a4, and builds kingside pressure while Black prepares. The line fails as a template when: Delaying the break beyond the moment of readiness until White's space squeeze becomes permanent.

STORE THIS | Preparation has an expiry date; break when every piece supports the transformation.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. The Breyer's moves reinforce e5 and organize the pieces so ...d5 can challenge White's center without tactical collapse. 2. Complete coordination, watch d5 and e4 tactics, and play the break when exchanges free the bishops and rooks. 3. White restrains ...d5, uses a4, and builds kingside pressure while Black prepares. 4. If ...d5 is played, which white capture or advance is strongest and where do the black pieces go afterward? 5. Delaying the break beyond the moment of readiness until White's space squeeze becomes permanent.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 28 plies from memory, then replay: 12. Bc2 Re8 13. Nf1 Bf8 14. Ng3 g6

SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 067 Decode: Vacating c6 for the c-pawn

Prompt: What concrete central or queenside move becomes possible only because c6 is empty?

Recall: Vacate a square only when another piece or pawn has a valuable claim to it.

LESSON 068 Play: Vacating c6 for the c-pawn

Prompt: What concrete central or queenside move becomes possible only because c6 is empty?

Recall: Vacate a square only when another piece or pawn has a valuable claim to it.

LESSON 069 Decode: The ...Bf8 defensive regrouping

Prompt: What square is the bishop defending now, and what event will release it later?

Recall: A good defensive piece prevents a break now and returns to activity later.

LESSON 070 Play: The ...Bf8 defensive regrouping

Prompt: What square is the bishop defending now, and what event will release it later?

Recall: A good defensive piece prevents a break now and returns to activity later.

LESSON 071 Decode: Preparing the freeing ...d5

Prompt: If ...d5 is played, which white capture or advance is strongest and where do the black pieces go afterward?

Recall: Preparation has an expiry date; break when every piece supports the transformation.

LESSON 072 Play: Preparing the freeing ...d5

Prompt: If ...d5 is played, which white capture or advance is strongest and where do the black pieces go afterward?

Recall: Preparation has an expiry date; break when every piece supports the transformation.

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's plan, White's plan, one candidate for the side to move, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

Vacating c6 for the c-pawn

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 O-O 9. h3 Nb8 10. d4 Nbd7

Decision: What concrete central or queenside move becomes possible only because c6 is empty?

Memory: Vacate a square only when another piece or pawn has a valuable claim to it.

CARD 2

The ...Bf8 defensive regrouping

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 O-O 9. h3 Nb8 10. d4 Nbd7 11. Nbd2 Bb7 12. Bc2 Re8 13. Nf1 Bf8

Decision: What square is the bishop defending now, and what event will release it later?

Memory: A good defensive piece prevents a break now and returns to activity later.

CARD 3

Preparing the freeing ...d5

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 O-O 9. h3 Nb8 10. d4 Nbd7 11. Nbd2 Bb7 12. Bc2 Re8 13. Nf1 Bf8 14. Ng3 g6

Decision: If ...d5 is played, which white capture or advance is strongest and where do the black pieces go afterward?

Memory: Preparation has an expiry date; break when every piece supports the transformation.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
067 Decode: Vacating c6 for the c-pawn	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
068 Play: Vacating c6 for the c-pawn	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
069 Decode: The ...Bf8 defensive regrouping	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
070 Play: The ...Bf8 defensive regrouping	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
071 Decode: Preparing the freeing ...d5	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
072 Play: Preparing the freeing ...d5	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name both sides' strongest plans, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.